TOPIC 1 · 40 MIN · GMAIL · CALENDAR · DRIVE · DOCS

Lab 1: Your Always-On Chief of Staff in Gmail, Calendar and Docs

> Five emails and a double-booking are waiting. Spark reads them before you do, and you practise telling it no.

Your goal

Connect Google Workspace, run a read-only inbox and calendar task, refuse an action, and write the agent boundary for Northstar Studio (LO1).

The story so far

Monday morning at Northstar Studio. A bakery wants a call, a motor shop wants a price you must not give, a yoga studio is unhappy, and two meetings clash on Tuesday. You have not opened your laptop yet. Before Spark touches any of it, you decide what it may read, what it may draft and what stays with you. That decision becomes the agent task contract your studio runs on.

You will deliver

- ☐ Northstar-Agent-Task-Contract in Google Docs: two recommended platforms, permission matrix, approval map
- ☐ A task thread showing the plan, the brief and one denied action
- ☐ One Gmail draft, unsent

Before you start

A personal Google Account on Google AI Pro or Ultra, age 18+, Keep Activity and Personal Intelligence on. A laptop with Chrome. Copy every prompt from labs/prompts.html, or from the course prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2026064173-AI-Agents-with-Gemini-Spark/labs/prompts.html

Your mock data

File in data/	What it is
northstar-content-inventory.csv	Approved and prohibited claims. Spark may only use these.
seed-emails.txt	Five made-up emails Spark drafts to you, ready for you to send to yourself.
northstar-calendar.ics	A week of made-up meetings with one clash. Import into a new calendar.
northstar-brand-guide.docx	Voice, colours and what the studio never says.
platform-notes.docx	Audience and channel notes for choosing two platforms.
agent-task-contract-template.docx	The contract Spark fills in: platforms, matrix, approvals, stop rules.
assets/northstar-logo.png	Fictional logo.

Steps

Step 1. Clear the gates and connect Workspace (5 min)

Where: gemini.google.com

Sign in with your personal Google Account on an AI Pro or Ultra plan. Confirm Task appears below the text box. Then open Settings, search for Connected Apps and turn on Google Workspace. Leave third-party apps off.

Expect: Task is visible and Google Workspace shows as connected. No Task button? Check age 18+, a personal account, Keep Activity on, Personal Intelligence on, then call your trainer.

Step 2. Set up Drive, Calendar and your test inbox (8 min)

Where: Google Drive, Google Calendar, then Gemini → Task

In Drive, create the folder Gemini Spark Workspace/Northstar and upload this lab's data folder into it. In Calendar, create a new calendar named Northstar Lab and import northstar-calendar.ics into it (Settings → Import & export). Then click Task, attach seed-emails.txt with Upload & tools, and paste the prompt. Open Gmail Drafts and send all five to yourself by hand.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Read the attached seed-emails.txt. Create five separate Gmail drafts addressed to me, one per email, with the subject and body exactly as written. Do not send anything. Tell me when the five drafts are ready.
```

Expect: Five drafts appear, and after you send them, five emails with [NORTHSTAR-LAB] in the subject sit in your inbox.
You decide: Spark may draft. You press Send. That is the first rung of the ladder.

Step 3. Get your first brief, read-only (8 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, new thread

Start a new task and paste the prompt. Read the plan before it runs, then click the progress chip and open the work panel. Note each step and the app it used.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Search only emails with [NORTHSTAR-LAB] in the subject and only my calendar named Northstar Lab for the next 7 days.
Give me one brief: who wants what, any deadline, which email needs me first, and any calendar clash.
Do not archive, label, reply, send, or change any event. Ask me before any change.
```

Expect: A plan first, then a brief naming the Tuesday clash and flagging Sarah's complaint. Gmail and Calendar are unchanged.
You decide: Whether the priority order is right. Spark does not know your clients. You do.

Step 4. Say no, and watch it stop (4 min)

Where: Same task thread

Paste the prompt. When Gemini asks for confirmation, deny it. Then ask for the draft version in the next step.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Reply to the [NORTHSTAR-LAB] email from Raj Motors and send it now.
```

Expect: Gemini asks before sending. After you deny, it stops and does not try another way.
You decide: Deny. Raj asked for a price and your rules forbid stating one.

Step 5. Save one safe reply as a draft (5 min)

Where: Same task thread

Attach northstar-content-inventory.csv, then paste the prompt. Open the draft in Gmail and check every claim against the inventory.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Using only the approved rows in the attached inventory, save a Gmail draft replying to Raj Motors.
Do not state a price. Offer the 20-minute discovery call. Under 100 words. Save it as a draft only.
```

Expect: One draft, no price, one clear next step. Nothing sent.
You decide: Edit it, or delete it. It leaves only when you send it.

Step 6. Have Spark fill the contract, then correct it (10 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, then Google Docs

Attach agent-task-contract-template.docx and platform-notes.docx, then paste the prompt. Open the Doc and correct anything you disagree with. The permission matrix must be yours, not Spark's.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Create a Google Doc named Northstar-Agent-Task-Contract in my Gemini Spark
Workspace/Northstar folder, following the attached template exactly.
Recommend two media platforms for the website rollout using the attached platform notes.
For each, state the audience, the action it drives, the owner, the risk and a KPI.
Fill the permission matrix for Gemini Spark, the coding agent and the human owner. Every
send, publish or pay action stays with the human owner.
```

Expect: A Doc with two justified platforms, a full permission matrix, an approval map and stop rules.
You decide: You change at least one line, then take the PP Task 1 screenshot.

Checkpoint

The inbox is unchanged, the denied send stopped dead, and every send, publish or pay row in your matrix sits with the human owner.

Assessment evidence

PP Task 1: ONE screenshot of your completed agent task contract showing the two platforms and the permission matrix.

If you finish early, or after class

• Type: Interview me about my work so you can set up my first task and skills. Google built this in, and about five questions later you have a working profile.

• Ask Spark to create a private Google Keep note listing your three stop rules.

If Spark does not behave as described

Menus move and results vary, so this lab states what to expect and not exact wording. Check the source in Google Help, tell your trainer, and record what you actually saw. No Pro or Ultra account in class? Pair with a neighbour and complete the Docs, Sheets and Sites templates by hand.

All company data in this lab (Northstar Studio, people, enquiries, reviews, numbers) is fictional and generated for training.